

14TH DISTRICT, ILLINOIS

THE SPEAKER

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Congress of the United States
House of Representatives
Washington, DC 20515-1314

June 26, 2001

Dear [REDACTED]

Thank you for contacting me about Unidentified Flying Objects (UFOs). I appreciate this opportunity to correspond.

Although little attention has been paid to the subject of UFOs in recent years, the controversy still excites nearly as much emotional response now as it did during the late 1940s. After 21 years of investigating UFOs, the Air Force concluded that whatever was being seen was not hostile, nor a threat to national security, and therefore needed no further inquiry. People have accepted this view, and media coverage is still rare in anything but tabloid and UFO organization publications.

You may know that during the 1960s, national interest in the subject of UFOs was so acute that two House Committees held hearings to learn more about the matter and quell concerns. In 1966, the Armed Services Committee held its hearing, and in 1968 the Science and Astronautics Committee held its hearing. These hearings served as forums into the issue, and did not attempt to solve the issue of UFOs.

The Armed Services Committee hearing dealt primarily with the United States Air Force reports on UFOs. After hearing testimony, Members of the committee expressed disbelief in extraterrestrial vehicles and confidence in the Air Force. The House Science and Astronautics Committee hearing excluded all Air Force material and heard testimony from various "experts" on the subject of UFOs. The witnesses called were primarily college professors and were unable to explain the UFOs due to lack of evidence.

I am unaware of any current congressional hearings dealing with UFOs, but I have taken the liberty of forwarding your comments to the House Science Committee for their review.

Thank you again for contacting me about this issue. If I can be of any further assistance, please do not hesitate to do so again.

6/29 Copy to →

for info.
JRC

Sincerely,

A black rectangular box with a white 'X' drawn across it, used to redact a signature.

Speaker

JDH:er